CfP: Breakthrough Listen TART Africa Programme 2026

Call Deadline: 1 May 2026

We are delighted to announce financial support from the Breakthrough Listen programme to extend the TART telescope network in Africa, in partnership with SARAO, DARA and Rhodes University. Up to five additional TART deployments and installation workshops across Africa will be funded by this call.

The call is open to African institutions or consortia interested in hosting a TART telescope. Hosts will be selected for funding based on their site readiness, sustainability, expected impact on Human Capacity Development in the country, and availability of co-funding.

Proposal for this call should be submitted as a PDF-format document (3 pages maximum) addressing the following questions:

- Description of host institution, number of faculty and students (potentially) involved in radio astronomy.
- Availability of co-funding for a TART telescope.
- Long-term sustainability of a TART telescope at the host institution: availability of funding and staff for operation, maintenance and scientific exploitation of the telescope
- Proposed telescope site[1] and site readiness.
- Ability and willingness of the host institution to organise an installation workshop. (Please address questions of lecturing venue(s), accommodation options, distance from the telescope site, the number of local students that would be joining, etc.)
- Availability of co-funding for the installation workshop[2].
- Composition of the local installation team and workshop LOC.
- Ability of the host institution to manufacture the TART array structure locally. This requires access to CNC tools for working with plywood, and basic fabricating skills[3].
- Expected impact of a TART installation in the country: number of students and faculty that could benefit from a TART at the host institution(s), proposed development of a scientific programme around the TART, etc.

Please submit your proposals by e-mail to cfp2026@tart.africa.

[1] Site characteristics: a secure, flat area of at least 5x5m (rooftop or ground) with a relatively unobscured view of the sky above 10° elevation. Power and internet (wired, wi-fi or 4G) must be available on site.
[2] It is expected that the host institution(s) will organise and fund the attendance of local participants.
[3] Prefabricated structures are available to be shipped at extra cost: local manufacture is preferred.